

Getting Clients using a “Branding Platforms” Strategy

Branding Platforms

- **Branding** is defined as “*The marketing practice of creating a name, symbol or design that identifies and differentiates a product from other products*”
(ref: entrepreneur.com encyclopedia)
- Secrets to branding: consistency and repetition
- For our purposes then, branding is “*regular communication with our audience wherein we continuously provide value, create goodwill and trust, and promote our offers*”
- **Platforms** = the channels, events and media used to communicate to an audience
 - e.g.: email, social media, events, and media, etc.
 - Can be our own platform (you own and control the assets) or an other’s platform (a third party hosts, controls and potentially owns, the assets)

Branding Platforms

Key Principles:

1. Continuously publish content to the platform that demonstrates our expertise, educates and entertains, and generates goodwill by providing value (or results) in advance.
 - Create a series of “Client Invitations” with automated follow ups that offer free coaching (or “Strategy Calls”).
 - In your content, offer a relevant Client Invitation
2. Periodically publish content that promotes an offer
 - Create a web page where people can learn about, and invest in, your offer
 - Include a call to action for people to invest in your coaching (or other programs)

Own-Platform Strategies

- The most important asset you can create in your business is a an audience- your “Tribe” - who knows, likes and trusts you
- In support of this idea, the most important thing you can do is create a platform you own (and control) for the purpose of building that audience and nurturing your relationship with it.
- Great news: creating your **own platform** has never been easier, more affordable, or popular
- Choose the media that suits you best (written, audio, video, social) and you can instantly start a program or event on some platform - often for free,

Other Platform Strategies

- You can leverage other brands' platforms to reach a new / bigger audience and grow your own audience
- You can partner with other brands to do promotional events to their audience
- You can have a presence on third-party media platforms
 - Caution: many people think of this as their “own” platform, but remember: the platform hosts your content, generally has full usage rights to it, controls the terms of service, and can disappear (remember MySpace?)
 - Even though you have a channel on a third party media platform - use it to add people to YOUR platform every chance possible (primarily, your email list)

Getting Clients: Your Own Platform

- Still today - email is the cornerstone of your platform. Prioritize as much of your platform communications to build your email list as possible.
- Strategies for using your own platform to create clients:
 - Create one or more “Client Invitation” offers with automated follow-up that promotes your free coaching or discovery call, e.g.:
 - Free coaching or discovery calls
 - Quizzes/assessments
 - “Trusted Advisor” survey campaign
 - Start a blog
 - Start a newsletter
 - Create your own (online) community
 - Host webinars and/or livestreams
 - Interview experts
 - Hold a virtual summit
 - Do a challenge
 - Hold a workshop or “Discovery Day”
 - Write a book
 - Create a program or course

Getting Clients: Other Platforms

- Ways to leverage other peoples' platforms:
 - Guest blogging - on individual blogs or media platforms like Huffington Post, Medium, Forbes, etc
 - Start a podcast
 - Start a social media channel: Facebook, Youtube, Instagram, LinkedIn
 - Get interviewed on other peoples channels/shows/podcasts
 - Appear in other challenges, summits and promotions